

Growth and Analytics Pod - All-Hands Update

Q4 2026 | November 2026 | Stephanie Wells

The Short Version

Northstar shipped on November 13, 2026. On time. On scope. NPS 9.3. All three pilot customers signed and live. That is 13 months of work from blank PRD to production. Thank you to Megan Shaw, Tomoko Hayashi, Ryan Iyer, Alex Park, Dana Cruz, Priya Nair, and James Okafor. They shipped this. I PM'd it.

Q4 Metrics

Metric	Target	Result	Delta
30-day pilot retention	40%	41.2%	+1.2pp
Pilot NPS	8.0	9.3	+1.3
Ship date	Nov 13, 2026	Nov 13, 2026	On time
P0 bugs in hypercare	0	0	Met
Support ticket reduction	30%	34%	+4pp
Sprint velocity S12 to S14	target 90%	92% average	Exceeded

How We Got Here (October 2025 to November 2026)

PRD v1.0 signed off October 2025. Beta launched January 15, 2026 with three pilot accounts. Ship date revised in February 2026 for scope fidelity. Feature freeze October 9, 2026. Pilot sign-off from all three accounts by November 8, 2026. GA launch November 13, 2026.

The Key Decision

Slipping the date in February was the right call. The product that shipped is better than what we would have rushed out earlier.

What Is Next: Q1 2027

In scope: NS-F009 Benchmark overlay; NS-F011 Enterprise API access (scoping); ClickHouse query optimization (Megan's team). Open questions: Tomoko Hayashi career conversation in December (retention risk flagged); API security review starting now, four-week backlog at the security team; PM capacity - Stephanie back to full in November, deputy process documented. Full roadmap: X12.xlsx.

Team Shoutouts

James Okafor: Safari memory leak, production fix in 18 hours. Megan Shaw: held the sprint through a compressed October. Priya Nair: messaging webhook microservice decision was the right call. Ryan Iyer: unblocked the cohort comparison pipeline on a weekend. Tomoko Hayashi: pilot customers named the funnel design specifically in their NPS comments. Alex Park: email digest idempotency fix at the last sprint, a clean save. Dana Cruz: cohort comparison table, five stars from Atlas Growth Labs.

Hypercare Period

November 13 to November 27, 2026: 14-day hypercare. Doubled on-call rotation, Megan Shaw leads. Daily 15-minute standup 9 AM PT. Escalation: Stephanie Wells, then Carlos Rivera. Rollback plan: feature flag disable, five-minute execution. Rollback tested and confirmed November 9, 2026. First post-hypercare retro: November 28, 2026.